

Coventry - culture and heritage regeneration

- **What have they done?:**
 - Invested heavily in the city centre. Council claims over £57 million invested in public spaces since 2011 (£10+ million in 2021) [source](#)
 - Revitalised areas
 - Upper precinct, market way, smithford way, hertford street, bull yard all redesigned with better paving, lighting, greenery, seating, artwork [\(specific details\)](#)
 - UK City of Culture 2021 regeneration opportunity and focused on inclusion, diversity, and civic engagement
 - Investment into cultural venues, heritage buildings, public spaces, creative industries
 - Increased funding and media attention
- **Why:**
 - Second world war damage caused coventry centre to need to be rebuilt but it was rebuilt with poor ideas so loads of traffic (cant find many websites talking about this and originally saw this on reddit but i thought it was funny to include)
 - Council wanted to make the centres appearance and accessibility better
 - Retail is falling so wanted to add more reason to come to the centre
 - Winning the city of culture allowed them to have an engaging reason to want to come to coventry so they wanted to play off of that and use it effectively
- **Location:**
 - Pedestrian and visitor areas in city centre (less industrial)
- **Effects:** [source](#)
 - £183 million economic benefit
 - £176 million direct investment
 - Regeneration valued at over £500 million since 2017
 - Didn't eliminate all problems - less commuting and shopping which is good but also bad, maybe because of less students [source](#)
- **Compare:**
 - Swindon is considering a Cultural Quarter at Kimmerfields which is largely culture based instead of industrial and retail. Compare to see if its good?